Soil testing checklist

Pick a paddock where a test could change what you put out. If the same patch keeps falling behind, that's a good place to start.

01 Choose your test set and targets wisely

- ☐ If a soil test comes with your fertiliser order, check what's included. What are you trying to explain in the crop or the grain results? Check the panel covers that before you pay for extras.
- ☐ If a full grid isn't in the budget, pick a patch that regularly yields well and one that falls behind. We use DataFarming NDVI imagery alongside yield records and paddock history, then walk both patches. Combine cores from the same zone and depth in one bag and save the GPS locations.
- ☐ Do some digging while the crop's up. If the roots stop short, a 0–100 mm sample can miss what's going on below it. A field pH check can flag a suspected acid layer. Agree depths with your adviser and lab, and send each layer separately.

02 Turn the readings into Nutrient requirements in kg/ha

- ☐ **At Hybrid-Ag, we calculate the kg/ha requirements for you.** Where the test shows a shortfall, we work out how much of that Nutrient would be needed per hectare to reach the soil target. Ask us to step you through the figures for your paddock.
- ☐ Work out how much of that shortfall is worth tackling this season alongside what the crop needs. See the soil report and blend example on page 3.

03 Adjust the program and choose the placement

- ☐ Put the figures beside what's already gone out and what's in the budget. If the planned blend already covers a requirement, leave it at that. If there's still a gap, look at timing and placement before lifting the rate.
- ☐ Where a change makes sense, compare a Hybrid-Ag prescription liquid or dry blend, including granular options. Work out what the proposed rate delivers in Nutrient kg/ha, what it costs per hectare and where your gear can put it.

See the paddock questions on page 2

Compare the two approaches on page 3

Check the panel. Plan the job.

Use your soil report to talk through what the paddock needs and what's worth doing this season.

What's included in the test?

Here's what one Hybrid-Ag report covered. Use it when comparing quotes and confirm which tests and lab methods you need for your paddock.

Exchange capacity
CEC / TEC, base saturation, Hydrogen percentage and Calcium to Magnesium ratio.

Soil condition
pH in water, electrical conductivity (EC) and organic Carbon.

Other Elements
Boron, Iron, Manganese, Copper, Zinc and Aluminium.

Major Elements and salts
Calcium, Magnesium, Potassium, Sodium, Chloride and Sulphur.

Nitrogen and Phosphorus
Nitrate and Ammonium Nitrogen. Colwell Phosphorus and Total Phosphorus reported separately.

Soil solution
Solution EC, Calcium, Magnesium, Potassium and Sodium.

Questions to ask about your paddock

- What are we trying to explain in this paddock? Which areas and depths should we sample separately?
- Where does the test show a Nutrient shortfall in kg/ha, and how much is worth tackling this season?
- How many kg/ha of that Nutrient are we already putting out, and how much more would the proposed blend supply?
- Where and when could we place the blend with the gear you've got? What would it cost per hectare, and when should we check the result?

Talk it through with Jimmy or Bruce

If you'd like to go through these questions for your paddock, have your soil report handy and ask for Jimmy or Bruce when you get in touch. You can also ask for webinar details once the date is set.

hybridag.com.au/contactus


James White


Bruce Armstrong

From the soil test to the prescription

This 0–10 cm sample shows what we'd work through with you before choosing a blend.

Soil analysis

EXAMPLE REPORT / 0–10 CM SAMPLE

CEC	TEC	pH (water)	Organic Carbon
4.12	5.38	5.90	1.13%

Cation balance

Base saturation	Found	Report target
Calcium	**50.00%**	64%
Magnesium	**11.52%**	15%
Potassium	**10.41%**	4–7%
Sodium	**1.49%**	0.5–1.5%

Total soil correction

kg/ha of each Element to reach the soil target

Calcium 378	Magnesium 58	Sulphur 67
Boron 4	Zinc 16	Copper 10

The targets and rounded kg/ha figures apply to this sample. How much to tackle this season is a separate decision.



What goes in the blend?

This sample is short of Calcium and Sulphur. We'd first check what your planned inputs already cover. If the crop needs both this season and liquid placement suits your gear, **Liqui-Gyp** is one option we'd assess. We'd then work out what the proposed blend supplies in kg/ha.

What do you get back from a soil test?

Compare	Conventional approach	The Hybrid-Ag approach
Analysis	What gets tested depends on the package your supplier offers. Some cover only the basics.	We start with a comprehensive soil panel, then tailor the testing to what you're seeing in the paddock. If roots stop at a particular depth, for example, we can test the layers separately to see what a topsoil sample might miss.
Interpretation	A basic report gives you raw readings, sometimes with a low-to-high "fuel gauge". It flags a shortage without telling you how many kg/ha you're short.	We calculate the shortfall in kg/ha for each relevant Nutrient and show the soil target behind it. You can see what needs correcting before choosing a blend.
Paddock plan	A recommendation may stop at a paddock rate for gypsum, dolomite or lime. How that fits the rest of the program can be left to you.	We draw on inputs from a range of suppliers to build a Hybrid-Ag prescription blend. We compare liquid and dry options, including granules, against your gear, placement, timing and cost per hectare.

Next time you test Go back to the same zones and depths at a similar time, using comparable lab methods. Look at what changed alongside what went out and how each patch yielded.